DIRECTORATE
MAHARASHTRA
TOURISM

MAHARASHTRA

THE LAND OF GASTRONOMIC EXTRAVAGANZA


POPTI


SHIRVALE RAS


KOMBDI WADE


VADA PAV


PURAN POLI


VANGYACHE BHARIT

Food reflects the culture, values, and history of a community, indicating regional identity through local ingredients and traditional recipes. In Maharashtra, diverse culinary practices showcase the state's rich agricultural heritage and vibrant culture. Each region boasts unique dishes that highlight local resources and flavors, fostering community connections through shared meals and culinary traditions.

Konkan cuisine is a delightful celebration of coastal flavors, characterized by the abundant use of fresh seafood, coconut, and local spices. This region's culinary identity is deeply tied to the sea, with dishes that showcase the bounty of its shores. One of the standout dishes is **Popti,** a traditional winter delicacy made with a mix of vegetables, chicken, and eggs, slow-cooked in an earthen pot for a smoky flavor. Another unique offering is **Shirvale Ras,** which features rice noodles served with sweetened coconut milk, highlighting the region's love for coconut.

Breakfast staples like **Amboli** and **Ghavne** are soft rice pancakes often enjoyed with spicy chutneys or curries, reflecting the simplicity and versatility of Konkan cuisine. For festive occasions, **Kombdi Wade,** a spicy chicken curry served with deep-fried rice flour puris, exemplifies the region's affinity for bold flavors and hearty meals. Refreshing drinks like **Kokum Sarbat** and **Solkadhi,** made from kokum fruit, aid digestion and cool the body in the coastal heat.

The iconic **Vada Pav,** a spiced potato fritter sandwiched in bread, has its roots in Konkan. With an enviable coastline, **Seafood** is the sheet anchor of the region's cuisine. A variety of fishes, prawns and crabs lend themselves admirably to signature dishes that celebrate the unique cuisine. Specific ingredients are used in traditional recipes that highlight the coastal flavors of this area. Grills, curries, batter fries or delicately cooked in coconut-based gravy, each of these dishes are an ode to a fabulous gastronomic union of seafood and land based spices.

Modak, a sweet Indian snack, is popular in Konkan. It has a soft rice flour shell that's steamed and filled with a sweet, aromatic mixture of grated coconut and jaggery. This signature dish known as "ukadiche modak" is a traditional offering during Ganesh Chaturthi.



"Maharashtra's cuisine is a vibrant reflection of our diverse culture and rich heritage. From the spicy misal pav of Mumbai to the delicate puran poli of Pune, and from the coastal seafood of Konkan to the rustic varhadi cuisine of Vidarbha, our state offers a gastronomic journey that's as diverse as it is delicious. Come, taste the authentic flavors of Maharashtra and experience the warmth of our hospitality."

GIRISH MAHAJAN,
Minister Of Tourism, Government Of Maharashtra